



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

*niḥspṛhaṃ mānasaṃ yasya nairāśye+api mahātmanaḥ |
tasyātmajñānatṛptasya tulanā kena jāyate | |3|12| |
svabhāvādeva jñāno dṛśyametanna kiñcana |
idaṃ grāhyamidaṃ tyājyaṃ sa kiṃ paśyati dhīradhīḥ | |3|13| |*

— Aṣṭāvakragītā, Prakaraṇa 3 (Chapter 3), Verses 12-13

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

The Aṣṭāvakragītā shines a light on the liberated being, and these verses beautifully illustrate the inner state of one who has realized their true Self. Verse 12 speaks of the great-souled individual, the *mahatma*, whose mind is free from longing, even amidst hopelessness. Think about that for a moment. To be utterly desireless, even when circumstances appear bleak, points to a profound inner contentment. This isn't about suppressing desires, but transcending them, recognizing that true fulfillment lies not in external acquisitions, but in the intrinsic joy of Self-knowledge. This person is already overflowing with the nectar of *atmajñana*, the wisdom of the Self. What comparison can there be for such a being? Nothing in the material world can equate to the boundless peace and fulfillment they experience.

Verse 13 delves deeper into the enlightened perception. The wise one, *dhīradhīḥ*, understands, inherently and spontaneously, that the world of appearances, the *dṛśyam*, is ultimately insubstantial. It's not that they deny the existence of the world, but they recognize its transient nature, its lack of ultimate reality. Because of this profound understanding, the distinctions of "this should be accepted" and "this should be rejected" lose their grip. They don't get caught up in the endless cycle of seeking and avoiding, because they see the unity underlying all experiences.

How does this apply to your life? Consider your own desires and aversions. How much energy do you spend chasing after things you think will make you happy, or running away from things you fear? The Aṣṭāvakragītā invites you to question these patterns. It's not about becoming apathetic or inactive, but about acting from a place of inner freedom, without being driven by the relentless demands of the ego. By cultivating detachment and recognizing the impermanent nature of all things, you can find a deeper sense of peace and contentment, regardless of your external circumstances. True freedom lies in recognizing your true Self, which is beyond all limitations.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

Can you identify one area in your life where you are clinging to a desire or aversion, and how might you begin to loosen that grip?